בס״ד

The `shiur` package

Source sheets (*dappei mekorot*) for handouts and slides

Gabriel Gendler Yom-Tov
shiurtex@thm.mozmail.com

Version 2.0, 29 October 2026

Introduction

`shiur` typesets Jewish source sheets: numbered sources, each in Hebrew with an English translation, with notes for the person giving the class (the *maggid shiur*). From one file of content it can produce:

- a handout for participants (*talmid*), and one with the teacher's notes (*maggid shiur*);
- a bilingual handout and a Hebrew-only one;
- a large-print handout;
- beamer slides, with long sources split over several slides.

Each version is a two- or three-line wrapper file around the shared content, so a correction made once appears in every version.

The package needs XeLaTeX and a font with Hebrew. It loads `polyglossia` (with English as the main language and Hebrew as the other), `geometry`, `fancyhdr`, `framed`, `xcolor` and `hyperref`, among others.

A first source sheet

```
\documentclass[11pt]{article}
\usepackage{shiur}
\setshiurfont{hebrew}{FreeSerif}

\title{Wheat from the clouds}
\author{A. Teacher}
\date{}

\begin{document}
\maketitle

\begin{mekor}
```

```
\begin{mekorlang}{hebrew}{בבלי מנחות ס"ט ע"ב}
בעי ר' זירא: חיטין שירדו בעבים מהו?
\end{mekorlang}
\begin{mekorlang}{english}{B. Mena\hdot ot 69b}
R. Zeira asked: ``if wheat descended in clouds, what is the law?''
\end{mekorlang}
\end{mekor}

\end{document}
```

`\setshiurfont{hebrew}{...}` chooses the Hebrew font, for handouts and slides alike. Without it, the package picks an installed font itself (see "Fonts"). Every page has בס״ד at the top right, the title page included; `\maketitle` prints the title as usual.

The source above comes out like this:

א. בבלי מנחות ס״ט ע״ב

בעי ר׳ זירא: חיטין שירדו בעבים מהו?

1. B. Menaḥot 69b

R. Zeira asked: "if wheat descended in clouds, what is the law?"

Sources

`mekor` and `mekor*`

A `mekor` holds one source and gives it the next number. A `mekor*` holds a source that continues the previous one, and takes no new number. On slides, each `mekor` is a frame.

`mekorlang`

```
\begin{mekorlang}[subtitle]{language}{title}
  text
\end{mekorlang}
```

Each language of a source is a `mekorlang`. Hebrew is set right to left with Hebrew numerals, and any other language left to right with arabic numerals. Hebrew has three names, which differ only in font (see "Fonts"): `hebrew` for most text, `mikra` for Tanakh, and `rashi` for text in Rashi script. The number of the source goes in the margin of a handout. The optional subtitle, in italics under the title, usually names the author or the translation:

```
\begin{mekorlang}[\attribution{R. Asher Weiss}{Jerusalem}{5780}]
```

```
  {english}{Min\hdot at Asher}
```

`\attribution{who}{where}{when}` joins its non-empty parts with commas, giving "R. Asher Weiss, Jerusalem, 5780".

Verse numbers

In a passage from Tanakh, `\pasuk` starts each verse with its number, and `\perek` starts a new chapter:

Command	English	Hebrew
`\pasuk`	the next verse: (19)	(יט)
`\pasuk[23]`	verse 23 of this chapter	(כג)
`\pasuk[37:18]`	chapter 37, verse 18	(לז יח)
`\perek{38}`	the start of chapter 38	(לח א)

Each `mekorlang` counts from scratch, so the Hebrew and its translation use the same commands and come out numbered alike. Where verses are left out, an ellipsis comes first: going from verse 20 to `\pasuk[23]` gives "... (23)". Moving on to the first verse of the next chapter counts as continuing, since the package can't know where a chapter ends; if you skipped the end of a chapter, use the starred form, `\pasuk*[39:1]` or `\perek*{39}`, which always puts an ellipsis first.

```
\begin{mekorlang}{mikra}{בראשית לז יח-כ, כג; לח א}
\pasuk[37:18] וַיִּרְאוּ אֹתוֹ מֵרָחֹק
\pasuk וְאִחָיו אֶל אִישׁ וַיֹּאמְרוּ
\pasuk וְנַהַרְגֵהוּ לְכוּ וְעַתָּה
\pasuk[23] וְיִהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר בָּא יוֹסֵף אֶל אֶחָיו
\perek{38} וְיִהִי בָּעֵת הַהִוא
\end{mekorlang}
```

ב. בראשית לז יח-כ, כג; לח א

(לז יח) וַיִּרְאוּ אֹתוֹ מֵרָחֹק (יט) וַיֹּאמְרוּ אִישׁ אֶל אָחִיו (כ) וְעַתָּה לְכוּ וְנַהַרְגֵהוּ ... (כג) וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר בָּא יוֹסֵף אֶל אֶחָיו
(לח א) וַיְהִי בָּעֵת הַהִוא

2. Genesis 37:18–20, 23; 38:1

(37:18) They saw him from afar (19) and said to one another (20) "Come now, let us kill him" ...
(23) When Joseph came to his brothers (38:1) At that time

On slides, the numbering carries on across a source split with `\mekorbreak`.

Leaving text out

`\dilug` marks a place where text is left out, in any source, translation or note: `said \dilug Why` gives "said ... Why". It keeps the ellipsis on the line of the word before it, and it never doubles up: straight before `\pasuk` or `\perek` it stands for the marker's own ellipsis, and at a `\mekorbreak` it merges with the break's. So to leave out the end of verse 22 and go on with verse 23, write `\dilug \pasuk`, or `\pasuk*`.

References

The references in headings come from the `mareimekomot` package, which `shiur` loads and which works in other documents too, such as papers and books. A reference is written once and comes out in the language around it, so a source's Hebrew and English headings use the same command:

Command	English	Hebrew
`\tanach{gen}{37:18-20}`	Genesis 37:18–20	בראשית ל״ז, י״ח–כ׳
`\tanach{exodus}{14}`	Exodus 14	שמות י״ד
`\tanach*{gen}{39:1}`	39:1	ל״ט, א׳
`\tanach[rashi]{gen}{18:7}`	Rashi on Genesis 18:7	רש״י על בראשית י״ח, ז׳
`\bavli{menachot}{69b}`	B. Menaḥot 69b	בבלי מנחות ס״ט ע״ב
`\bavli{yoma}{9a-b}`	B. Yoma 9a–b	בבלי יומא ט׳ ע״א–ע״ב
`\bavli*{127b}`	127b	קכ״ז ע״ב
`\mishnah{sukkah}{4:1}`	M. Sukkah 4:1	משנה סוכה ד׳, א׳
`\yerushalmi{berachot}{1:1}`	Y. Berakhot 1:1	ירושלמי ברכות א׳, א׳
`\shulchanaruch{oh}{605:1}`	Shulḥan Arukh, Oraḥ Ḥayyim 605:1	שו״ע או״ח סי׳ תר״ה סע׳ א׳
`\tur{yd}{114}`	Tur, Yoreh De'ah 114	טור יו״ד סי׳ קי״ד
`Rashi \sham`	Rashi ad loc	רש״י שם

A Tanakh reference is a chapter (`14`), a verse (`37:18`), or a range within a chapter (`37:18-20`) or across chapters (`37:18-38:2`); the starred form leaves out the book's name, for an addition such as "(+39:1)", and `\bavli*` gives a daf alone. A daf is `69b`, `69`, `69b-70a` or `9a-b`. Books and tractates are named in English, ignoring case, spaces and hyphens, with common short forms: `gen`, `kings ii`, `avoda zara`, `menachot`; the full lists are in `mareimekomot.sty`. Write them in whatever transliteration you use: *ch*, *kh* and *h* count alike, as do *tz*, *ts* and *z*, and *y* and *i*, and doubled letters and a final *h* don't matter, so `menachot`, `menakhot` and `menahot` are the same. Commands with ח or כ in their names can be spelt either way too: `\tanach` or `\tanakh`, `\shulchanaruch` or `\shulkhanarukh`. The English printed is transliterated with *ḥ* for ח and *kh* for כ (Menaḥot, Berakhot).

A commentary on a verse is named in the optional argument: `rashi`, `ramban`, `ibnezra`, `rashbam`, `radak`, `sforno`, `chizkuni`, `orhachaim`, `baalhaturim`, `kliyakar`, `malbim`, `onkelos` or `yonatan`. `\sham` after one stands for the verse, so "Ibn Ezra `\sham`" can follow it. `\declarecommentary` adds more, in the preamble:

```
\declarecommentary{haamekdavar}{העמק דבר}{Ha'amek Davar}
```

`\rambam{shofar}{2:6}` gives

Mishneh Torah, Laws of Shofar, Sukkah and Lulav 2:6
משנה תורה הלכות שופר וסוכה ולולב ב׳, ו׳

Mishnah and Yerushalmi references, and the Mishneh Torah's, are a chapter and its mishnah, halakhah or law, written like a Tanakh reference; the Shulḥan Arukh's and the Tur's are a siman, optionally with a se'if (`605:1`) or a range of se'ifim (`658:1-2`), in one of the four sections `oh`, `yd`, `eh` and `hm`. The Mishneh Torah's sets of laws are named by short keys such as `shofar`, `teshuvah` or `yesodeihatorah`; all 83, with their keys, are listed in `mareimekomot.sty`.

Works arranged by the Tur's four sections work the same way. Besides `\tur` and `\shulchanaruch`, the package has `\beityosef`, `\darkeimoshe`, `\bach`, `\aruchhashulchan`, and the commentaries `\shach`, `\taz`, `\magenavraham` and `\mishnahberurah`, whose sub-unit is the se'if katan:

Command	English	Hebrew
`\shach{yd}{114:3}`	Shakh, Yoreh De'ah 114:3	ש״ך יו״ד סי׳ קי״ד ס״ק ג׳
`\darkeimoshe{oh}{605:3}`	Darkei Moshe, Oraḥ Ḥayyim 605:3	דרכי משה או״ח סי׳ תר״ה אות ג׳
`\mishnahberurah{605:3}`	Mishnah Berurah 605:3	משנה ברורה סי׳ תר״ה ס״ק ג׳

The Magen Avraham and the Mishnah Berurah cover Oraḥ Ḥayyim only, so they take just the reference, and don't name the section. `\declaretursefer` declares more such works, in the preamble:

```
\declaretursefer[seifkatan]{\pitcheiteshuvah}{פתחי תשובה}{Pitchei Teshuvah}
\declaretursefer[seifkatan, section=oh]{\shaarhatziyun}
  {שער הציון}{Shaar haTziyun}
```

Its options are `seifkatan` for a sub-unit of ס״ק rather than ׳סע, `subunit=` for any other (the Darkei Moshe's is אות), and `section=` for a work on one section only.

Hebrew numbers take a geresh when they are one letter and gershayim when they are more (ח׳, ל״ח), ranges take an en dash, and a reference only breaks across lines at its dash.

`\sham` gives שם or "ad loc". On slides, where a source can be several slides from the one it refers to, it also gives that reference: "Rashi ad loc (B. Menaḥot 69b)". A source whose heading has no reference of the package's (a Tur or a midrash, say) clears it, so `\sham` after it stays plain rather than pointing at the wrong source. A reference never hyphenates; it breaks only between the words of a long name, as in the Mishneh Torah's, and at the dash of a range. Two settings change the style, in any document:

```
\mareimekomotsetup{sham=full}    % always give the reference after ad loc
\mareimekomotsetup{daf=short}    % a daf as :סט rather than ע״ב ס״ט
```

Notes

Notes are the maggid shiur's commentary: questions to ask, points to make, transitions. They are printed only in the `maggidshiur` version, beside a grey bar on the side where their lines start.

```
\begin{hearah}
Why does R. Zeira ask about wheat rather than any other food?
\end{hearah}

\begin{hearah}[hebrew]
בעברית. הערה
\end{hearah}
```

> Why does R. Zeira ask about wheat rather than any other food?

> הערה בעברית.

The optional argument is the language of the note, English by default; `hebrew`, `mikra` and `rashi` all give a Hebrew note. A `hearah` can go anywhere: between sources, or inside a `mekor`, before its text to introduce it or after its text to follow it. That position matters on slides: when a source is split over several slides (see "Splitting a long source over several slides"), a `hearah` before its text goes on the first slide and one after it on the last.

Options

Option	Effect
`talmid`	Leave out the notes. This is the default.
`maggidshiur`	Print the notes.
`translations=false`	Leave out each English `mekorlang` that follows a Hebrew one in the same source. Sources written in English, with no Hebrew before them, stay.
`accessible`	Set the handout in large print: 18 pt type, with every other size scaled to match, and unjustified text (ragged right for English, ragged left for Hebrew). Slides are unchanged.
`accessible=`*size*	The same, at another size, e.g. `accessible=20pt`.

When one version needs text that another doesn't, `\iftranslations{A}{B}` typesets *A* in the bilingual version and *B* in the Hebrew-only one:

```
\iftranslations{\begin{hearah}A note about the translation.\end{hearah}}{}
```

One body, several versions

The quickest start is the `newshiur` script in the package's `scripts` folder:

```
newshiur --author "A. Teacher" wheat
```

makes a folder `wheat` holding

- `wheat_body.tex`, the content, with a sample section;
- `wheat.tex`, the participants' handout;
- `wheat_presenter_notes.tex`, the handout with the notes;
- `wheat_beamer.tex`, the slides.

Its options:

`--hebrew-only`, `--large-print` add those versions of the handout;

`--title`, `--author`, `--font` set the title, the author and the Hebrew font (the title is otherwise made from the name);

`--here` puts the files in the current folder rather than a new one.

The environment variables `SHIUR_AUTHOR` and `SHIUR_HEBREW_FONT` give your usual author and font. The title, author and font go at the top of the body, so they are set once for every version. Write the shiur in the body, and compile the wrappers. The rest of this section explains how the files fit together.

Put everything from `\begin{document}` to `\end{document}` in a body file, and give each version a small file of its own. If the versions differ only in options, the body can hold the whole document, preamble included, and each version passes its options before reading it:

```
% shiur_hebrew.tex
\PassOptionsToPackage{translations=false}{shiur}
\input{shiur_body}
```

```
% shiur_notes.tex
\PassOptionsToPackage{maggidshiur}{shiur}
\input{shiur_body}
```

Handouts and slides from one body

A handout and a beamer presentation need different document classes, so each keeps its own preamble and reads the body with `\input`. The handout loads `beamerarticle` before `shiur`, so the body can use beamer's commands in both:

```
% shiur.tex: the handout
\documentclass[11pt]{article}
\usepackage{beamerarticle}
\usepackage[talmid]{shiur}
\input{shiur_body}
```

```
% shiur_slides.tex: the presentation
\documentclass{beamer}
\usepackage{shiur}
\input{shiur_body}
```

What every version shares can go at the top of the body, before `\begin{document}`: it is read after each wrapper has loaded the package, so it is still part of the preamble, and a change there reaches every version:

```
% shiur_body.tex
\title{Wheat from the clouds}
\author{A. Teacher}
\date{}
\setshiurfont{hebrew}{FreeSerif}

\begin{document}
\maketitle
...
\end{document}
```

In the body:

- `\mode<presentation>{...}` holds material for the slides only, such as a frame of photographs, and `\mode<article>{...}` material for the handout only;
- `\maketitle` makes a title on the handout and a title frame on the slides.

Splitting a long source over several slides

A source too long for one slide can be split with `\mekorbreak`, placed at the same point in each language. The handout ignores it and prints the source whole. On the slides, the source stays one frame, with one slide for each part. Every slide repeats the headings, and an ellipsis marks each side of a cut, replacing any punctuation there:

```
\begin{mekor}
\begin{mekorlang}{hebrew}{קיז תהלים}
כָּל־הָאֻמִּים׃ שַׁבְּחוּהוּ כָּל־הָעֻמִּים אֶת־יְהוָה הַלֵּלוּ
\mekorbreak
הַלְלוּיָהּ׃ לְעוֹלָם וָאֶמֶת יְהוָה חֶסֶד וְעַל־נוּ גָּבַר כִּי
\end{mekorlang}
\begin{mekorlang}{english}{Psalm 117}
Praise the Lord, all you nations; extol Him, all you peoples.
\mekorbreak
For great is His steadfast love toward us...
\end{mekorlang}
\end{mekor}
```

`\mekorbreak*` splits without the ellipses, where nothing is cut, for example where a question ends and its answer begins.

Fonts

Hebrew text has three roles, each with its own font:

`hebrew` rabbinic and other text, and every role's fallback;

`mikra` Tanakh. Its *trop* (cantillation marks) sits beside and among the vowels, and only some fonts position it well;

`rashi` text in Rashi script, such as a commentary printed in it.

Choose a role's font in the preamble, with any of `fontspec`'s options before or after the name:

```
\setshiurfont{hebrew}{Frank Ruehl CLM}
\setshiurfont{mikra}{Taamey Frank CLM}
\setshiurfont{rashi}{Noto Rashi Hebrew}
\setshiurfont{mikra}{TaameyFrankCLM}[Path=fonts/, Extension=.ttf,
  UprightFont=*-Medium, BoldFont=*-Bold]
```

A role you don't set gets the first of these fonts that is installed, and the log says which:

Role	Fonts tried, in order
`hebrew`	Taamey Frank CLM, Ezra SIL, Keter YG, Noto Serif Hebrew, FreeSerif
`mikra`	Taamey Frank CLM, Taamey David CLM, Ezra SIL, SBL Hebrew, Keter YG
`rashi`	Noto Rashi Hebrew

If none of a role's fonts is installed, `mikra` and `rashi` use the `hebrew` font, and `hebrew` ends with FreeSerif, which comes with TEX Live. Documents that set `\hebrewfont` (or `\hebrewfontsf` in beamer) with `\newfontfamily` keep that font as the `hebrew` one. A `mikra` or `rashi` font that lacks some punctuation, as Rashi fonts often do, borrows it from the `hebrew` font.

The sample sheet `shiur-fonts.pdf`, next to this manual, shows all three roles in use.

Fonts for trop

A general Hebrew font may have every trop mark and still place them badly, crowding a mark against a vowel or setting it off its letter. Figure 1 shows the same verses in FreeSerif and in Taamey Frank CLM, a font made for trop.

So that nobody's source sheet is let down by its fonts without their knowing, the package warns when a `mikra` source with trop is set in a font that isn't known to handle it, unless you chose that font yourself with `\setshiurfont`. The warning appears once per document, among LATEX's warnings, and says what to install. These fonts handle trop well, and are free:

בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ׃ וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ FreeSerif
בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ׃ וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ Taamey Frank CLM

Figure 1: Genesis 1:1–2 in a general font and in a font made for trop.

Ezra SIL from SIL International (`https://software.sil.org/ezra/`); on Debian and Ubuntu, `sudo apt install fonts-sil-ezra`.

Taamey Frank CLM and Taamey David CLM, from the Culmus project (`https://culmus.sourceforge.io`).

Keter YG also from Culmus; on Debian and Ubuntu, `sudo apt install fonts-culmus`.

SBL Hebrew from the Society of Biblical Literature, free for non-commercial use.

For Rashi script, Noto Rashi Hebrew is part of Google's free Noto fonts.

Other commands

`\hdot`, `\Hdot` ḥ and Ḥ, for transliteration (Ḥanukah).

`\sectionsymbol` §.

`boxedtext` text in a box, on handouts and slides.

Licence

Copyright 2023–2026 Gabriel Gendler Yom-Tov. This work may be distributed and/or modified under the conditions of the LaTeX Project Public License, either version 1.3c of this license or (at your option) any later version.